

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠J

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠Q

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: South
Lead: ♣K

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣A

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦K

Board: 6
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 6NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠3

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 7 3
♥ Q 10
♦ J 10 9 5 2
♣ K 6 5

♠ A Q 4

♥ A 9 6

♦ 8 3

♣ A J 10 7 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 10 9 8 5

♥ K J 8 7 4

♦ —

♣ Q 9 8

♠ 6 2

♥ 5 3 2

♦ A K Q 7 6 4

♣ 4 2

West	North	East	South
			2♦
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by North			
Lead: ♠J			

With 11 points and a beautiful 6-card suit this is the perfect hand for a Weak-2 opener. So you open 2♦. Partner responds 2NT.

Partner's 2NT bid is a standard response to a Weak 2-bid. You are expected to rebid your suit if you have a minimum (6-8 point) hand. Otherwise you are to bid an outside suit in which you hold a high card - this is called "showing a feature". And the final possibility is this one, where you have a solid suit, either A K Q x x x or A K J 10 x x. In this case you bid 3NT.

South would play 3NT.

North plays 3NT. East leads ♠J. West plays ♠K.

North plays 3NT. East leads ♠J. West plays ♠K.

Winner count: ♠ 2 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 3 : ♣ 1 : Total = 7

The ♠ lead assures you of two tricks in the suit. So you only need to create two more. If the ♦s split 3-2 (likely) you could get 3 extra tricks there. But there's a danger - if they split 4-1 you wouldn't have an entry to them. Well, you wouldn't have an entry unless you **DUCKED** the first ♦. Then a 4-1 split wouldn't prevent you from making 5 ♦ winners.

So you win the ♠A and lead the ♦3, planning to duck.

East shows out.

Make **PLAN B**, then

So you win the ♠A and lead the ♦3, planning to duck.

East shows out.

That's tough. No matter how you play them you can only get 3 ♦ winners. So you must turn elsewhere - elsewhere being the ♣ suit.

Win the ♦Q but don't play another ♦ yet, you need an entry back to dummy later. Instead, lead the ♣2 and finesse your ♣10. East will win with one of the high ♣s and probably return a ♠. You may as well take the ♠Q now. Play your ♦8 to dummy's ♦K, cash the ♦A, then play the ♣4, finessing your ♣J. Fortunately this wins and when you cash your ♣A both defenders follow. The rest of your clubs are good and you make an overtrick.

Sometimes you have to change your plan.

When the ♦s turned out to be 5-0 you had to get lucky. Your back-up Plan wasn't likely to work - it required the missing ♣ honors to be split, but also required a 3-3 ♣ split, not a likely outcome.

But there was no other choice so you have to try it.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ 6 5
♥ K 9
♦ 8 7 6 4 2
♣ A 8 5 3

♠ 9 4
♥ Q 5 2
♦ Q 10 9
♣ Q J 9 6 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K 7 2
♥ A J 10 8 7 4
♦ K 5
♣ 4

♠ Q J 10 8 3
♥ 6 3
♦ A J 3
♣ K 10 7

West	North	East	South
		1♥	1♠
Pass	Pass	3♥	Pass
4♥			
All Pass			
4♥ by East			
Lead: ♠Q			

he was going to win anyway.

You will lose two ♦s and the ♥Q but no more.

It is tempting to ruff the first ♠ with dummy's ♥9, hoping to sneak that through then ruff the second one with ♥K.

The problem is that North would have over-ruffed the ♥9 and then played another ♥ and you would not have gotten to ruff either ♠,

You open 1♥, South overcalls 1♠ and partner passes.

You shouldn't let South steal from you so you will bid your ♥s again. You must decide between 2♥ and 3♥. Given that partner might have had a pretty decent hand yet still have to pass, you decide to go with 3♥. Partner bids 4♥.

East plays 4♥. South leads the ♠Q.

East plays 4♥. South leads the ♠Q.

Losers: ♠ 2 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 0 : Total = 5

Win the ♠K, then enter dummy with the ♣A and play another ♠ toward your ♠A. You do this to prevent North ruffing your high ♠. Next you lead the ♠2 and ruff with dummy's ♥K. Ruff a ♣ to get back to your hand and ruff the ♠7 with dummy's ♥9. North may over-ruff this, but only with a trump trick

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 3 2
♥ 9 5
♦ Q 8 7 2
♣ K Q 10 9

♠ J 9 8 5 4

♥ Q 6

♦ J 10 4

♣ A 7 2



♠ K 10 7 6

♥ 8 3 2

♦ K 6 5

♣ J 8 4

♠ A

♥ A K J 10 7 4

♦ A 9 3

♣ 6 5 3

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	1♠	Pass	3♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			
4♥ by South			
Lead: ♣K			

You respond 1♠, your 5-card Major. Partner jumps to 3♥.

Make your next bid.

Partner is showing 16-18 points and you have 9. Since he rebid ♥s he must have at least six of them you you know there is an 8-card fit. You bid 4♥.

North would play 4♥.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♣K.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♣K.

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 2 : Total = 4

You might consider setting up dummy's ♠ suit for a discard but there are too few entries to make that work.

More promising is playing East to have at least one of the ♦ honors and taking two finesses in that suit. **BUT**, entries are still a problem. You can only reach dummy twice, once with the ♣A and once with the ♥Q, and you must play ♦s each time you are there.

Win the first trick with the ♣A and play the ♦J, letting it ride if East doesn't cover. West will win this trick and take two ♣s. He will probably then lead a ♠. You win your ♠A, play ♥A then a small ♥ to dummy's ♥Q. Now lead a ♦ and finesse with your ♦9. When this wins, pull trumps and claim.

Taking two finesses in ♦s will be successful whenever East holds the ♦K **OR** the ♦Q **OR** both the ♦K Q.

This will happen about 75% of the time, so the double finesse is a good Plan. And on this Deal it was the only plan available.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 7
 ♥ A K Q 8 6 2
 ♦ A 5
 ♣ Q 9 5 3

♠ 9 8 4

♥ J 5

♦ 10 9 8

♣ A K 10 7 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A J 6 5 2

♥ 10 4

♦ Q 7 4 3

♣ J 6

♠ K Q 10 3

♥ 9 7 3

♦ K J 6 2

♣ 8 2

West	North	East	South
1♥	Pass	1♠	Pass
3♥	Pass	4♥	
All Pass			
4♥ by West			
Lead: ♣A			

You respond with your 5-card Major, 1♠.

Partner jumps to 3♥.

With partner's 16-18 points you probably have enough strength for game.

With partner's six ♥s you have an 8-card fit.

So you bid 4♥.

East would play 4♥.

West plays 4♥. North leads ♣A, ♣K, ♣4. South plays ♣8 then ♣2.

West plays 4♥. North leads ♣A, ♣K, ♣4. South plays ♣8 then ♣2.

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 3 : Total = 4

Suppose you discard a ♦ from dummy. If South doesn't ruff this ♣10 then your ♣Q will win. You could then try to establish dummy's ♦Q to discard your fourth ♣ on.

But you know that plan won't work because South **IS** going to ruff this ♣ if you discard. You only have one chance to make this contract, and that is the chance that South was not dealt the ♥J. So you ruff with dummy's ♥10 and pray South doesn't over-ruff.

The prayer was answered, South did not hold the ♥J.

So you won that trick and still had your ♣Q to use after you pulled trumps.

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A J 10 8 4

♥ 4 3

♦ 10 7 4

♣ K 10 3

♠ Q 7

♥ K Q 8 7 6 5 2

♦ 8 5 2

♣ 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 9 5 2

♥ 9

♦ K Q J 9

♣ Q J 7 5

♠ 6 3

♥ A J 10

♦ A 6 3

♣ A 9 8 4 2

West

North

East

South

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

Lead: ♦ K

trump. Play a ♥ to the ♥ 10 and ruff the ♣ 4 with a high trump. Play a ♥ to the ♥ J and ruff the ♣ 8 with a high trump. Play a ♥ to the ♥ A and discard a loser on the good ♣ 9.

It took a 4-3 ♣ split to make this contract.

Fortunately that occurs a high percentage of the time. In any case, there was no other hope.

Responding to preempts is easy. You don't count points, you just count tricks. Assume partner for 6 tricks and add yours to see how high to go (or not go).

Here, with three Aces and a possible ♠ ruff you raise to game.

South would play 4♥.

North plays 4♥. West leads the ♦ K.

Things look grim. The defense has exposed your ♦ losers already and those two ♠ losers seem pretty obvious also. If you are to make this contract you must do so before you lose the lead. That means you must establish the ♣ suit **NOW**.

Win the ♦ A, play ♣ A and ruff the ♣ 2 with a high

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 8 6
 ♥ A 8 4
 ♦ A Q 8
 ♣ Q J 10 7

♠ A 4 2

♥ 10 9 5 3

♦ 7 4 2

♣ 5 4 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 10 5

♥ K Q 6

♦ K J 10 3

♣ A K 9

♠ Q 9 7 3

♥ J 7 2

♦ 9 6 5

♣ 8 6 2

West	North	East	South
4NT	Pass	1NT	Pass
All Pass		6NT	
6NT by East			
Lead: ♠ 3			

Your goal is simple, you must win one ♠ trick before you lose two. So the crux of your problem is: Who holds the ♠ A and ♠ Q?

If South has both of them you are guaranteed to win the first trick no matter what you play.

If North has both of them you are going to lose the first two tricks no matter what you play.

The problem is to decide what to do if they are split. The answer relies on psychology, not on probability. South has made an attacking lead. But if you were South would you start out leading a low ♠ from a suit like ♠ A 9 7 3? That would be incredibly foolhardy, you would probably lead a different suit and save your ♠ A for catching something high from declarer. On the other hand you would be quite likely to lead a small card from ♠ Q 9 7 3.

Your PLAN should be to play low in dummy and win your ♠ 10 if North withholds the ♠ A.

If you think South has ♠ A 9 7 3 then you should play the ♠ K from dummy. But if you think South has ♠ Q 9 7 3 you should play low from dummy.

Since South is unlikely to underlead an Ace against 6NT you play North for the ♠ A.

You have 16 points - a pretty solid 16 in fact. Partner has 15, 16 or 17, so together you have 31, 32 or 33. You want to invite partner to bid 6NT if he has 17, but to decline if he has 15. The correct bid for this invitation is 4NT. It is called a "quantitative" 4NT since it is just an invitational raise. It is **NOT** Blackwood - if you wanted to ask for Aces you would use Gerber.

Partner bids the slam.

West would play 6NT.

East plays 6NT. South leads the ♠ 3.

East plays 6NT. South leads the ♠ 3.

Winner count: ♠ 0 : ♥ 3 : ♦ 4 : ♣ 4 : Total = 11

It's pretty clear which suit you have to worry about!